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The Kennedy Magnetic Marketing
Special Report

SPECIALIZED
MAGNETIC MARKETING
INFORMATION

How To (At Least) Double The Results From Yellow Pages Advertising

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WHY YOU CANNOT LISTEN TO THE YELLOW PAGES REPS OR "COPYCAT" AND ACHIEVE EXCEPTIONAL RESULTS

First of all, the Rep's job is to get as much money out of you as possible and there is no guarantee that his/her objective matches up with yours: best return-on-investment possible. Second, everything he/she knows is about traditional advertising, NOT direct-response advertising. And, since direct-response type ads very rarely appear in this media, the Reps do not understand them and assume they are "bad ads" insisted upon by misguided advertisers. Instead, the Reps will tend to direct you into "copycatting" what most other YP advertisers do....even though this is a guaranteed path to mediocrity, to "average" results.

SIZE

Unlike any other advertising media, all advertisers are limited to the same maximum size; no matter how much bigger or richer your biggest competitor is, the biggest ad he can buy is a full-page. So there is a restricted, relatively fair playing field here. This means, if you choose to go with a big ad, you can automatically appear as "big" as any other advertiser to your prospects. Look at two big ads in your YP - can you tell by looking which is the bigger, more successful company? No. One could be the largest international conglomerate in the category, the other could be a one man shop, and you can't tell which is which. This, plus favorable position, are the two most often advanced arguments for buying a big/biggest ad, and they have validity.

And, there's sufficient statistical and case study evidence to satisfy me that, in general, when you double the size of a Yellow Pages ad, you do not just double the response; you triple or quadruple it. (The chart on the following page illustrates this disproportionate gain.)

However, here's the caveat: bigger/biggest size only works to your greatest advantage if/when you have a strong sales message to fill the space. If everything you have to say about your business fits on a business card, just enlarging that to a full page is a lousy investment.

And, tied to this idea, you do NOT need the biggest ad to win big. Message IS more important than size.

THE MOST IMPORTANT THING YOU NEED TO KNOW ABOUT CRAFTING YOUR ADVERTISING MESSAGE

Your logo, your company name, those things recognized readily by your customers are of minimal importance in Yellow Pages advertising. Using your business name as the ad's headline, for example, is a complete, utter and ignorant waste of space. Here's why:

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FACT #1: 60% of those who consult a category in the YP have NO company in mind. They are NOT looking for a name they already know. They are completely open-minded. They are there to be sold.

FACT #2: Of the 40% who do know a business in that categroy, 1/3rd are willing to be swayed from the one they know about to a different one. In total, 6 out of 10 are Fair Game for you. (See Illustration, next page.)

FACT #3: You will NOT attract/convince these 6 out of 10 with your name, logo, a cute slogan.

WARNING: Some experts, including some YP reps will advise you against mentioning service, guarantees, warranties, etc. and will advise sticking just to 'basic facts' (the same ones everybody else provides), such as location, hours, phone number, etc. This is very, very bad advice. They are creating an over-sized business card; you are supposed to be creating an ad.

Talk to the 6 out of 10 "in search of" someone to trust and tell them why they should choose you versus all the other advertisers.

THE MOST POWERFUL "SECRET WEAPON" OF THE YP ADVERTISER WHO GETS EXTRAORDINARY RESULTS

In all other types of advertising, most pros acknowledge that 70% of the battle is won or lost with the headline. Yet, incredibly, unbelievably, 99% of all YP ads do NOT have a headline. (They replace it with the business name, a cross-street location, or nothing at all.) When you put a benefit-driven, attention-getting headline on a YP ad you instantly gain a profound competitive edge over most, maybe all other advertisers in your category.

Listen carefully to everything said about Headlines in my MAGNETIC MARKETING SYSTEM and apply it all to writing a powerful Headline for your Yellow Pages ad.

60% of Yellow Pages Prospects Have NO Company In Mind

Are They Waiting To Be "WON" ..... BY YOU?

And of the 40% Who Have A Company In Mind.....

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ONE THIRD are ready to be swayed to another company....YOURS?

THE OTHER MISSING INGREDIENT

Most YP ads also lack another key, mandatory component of a direct-response ad: an offer or offers. Refer to everything said about "Secondary Reason For Response" and "Widgets" in the MAGNETIC MARKETING SYSTEM.

ACTUAL YP ADS WITH COMMENTS

The last pages in this Report are copies of actual Yellow Pages advertisements. Here are my comments about the major points they illustrate:

1. PHOENIX SERVICE CENTER

This is an outstanding full-page ad in the appliance repair category. It has a big, bold headline with one of the most powerful words of all: FREE. It has "credibility builders" in several places, like "Family Owned & Operated Since 1974" and "Best Tech Awards" and "17 Years Same Management."

2. DESIGN-BUILD ASSOCIATES

Here's a strong headline and a strong promise: "we get it done on target, on time, on budget." Unfortunately, there's little follow-through. This ad desperately needs an Offer.

3. PREACH BUILDING

Sin #1: Using the company name in place of a Headline. This squanders a wonderful opportunity because of top right positioning. The ad itself says very little. There's a routine list of items they carry. Where is there ANY reason to call them instead of anybody else/everybody else in their category? They've paid for a size advantage, then wasted the opportunity.

4. CLASSY CLOSETS

The best Headline in the whole category: "Double Your Closet Space" could be stronger - for egs.: "Double Your Closet Space At An Incredibly Low Cost, Almost Overnight! - Satisfaction Guaranteed! Too much space given to their name; too little to the Headline.

5. UUCS

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Here is an "advertorial" type of ad, which you rarely see in the Yellow Pages - and which can be very effective. This ad also has an Offer. Unfortunately, the freebie sounds difficult to get. The copy is too jargon-laden, not benefit-laden. But overall, effective.

6. SOLID GOLD SOUND

Here's one of the most powerful YP ads I've seen this year. In this case, the business' name works as a headline. The graphics help the ad. Note two free Offers right up top. Note: testimonials. On a 1-10, this is a '10.'

7. RESUME EXPERTS

A powerful ad damaged by a total black reverse, making everything too difficult to read. A very strong Headline, though, and good 'bullet points.' Fitting in a block of copy defining "everything" would be very helpful.

8. ROBINETT ROOFING

Here's a wonderful example of a silly waste of headline space. The only reason anybody is in this categroy is that they have a roof problem, but they've wasted the most valuable 15% of their ad space on this. Everything in the ad is "me-too" with every other advertiser. The opportunity to stand out is with their Guarantee, but they dropped that ball, too.

9. PADDOCK POOLS

A great, stand-out Headline, incorporating a Meaningful Specific. This makes the phone ring.

THE SECRET REASON WHY "YELLOW PAGES ADVERTISING" (OR OTHER ADVERTISING) DOESN'T WORK

Here's what I discovered when I was doing a lot of consulting work in the chiropractic profession. The phone rings; it is a prospective patient calling because of the Yellow Pages ad. The C.A. (Chiropractic Assistant) and/or receptionist answers the phone. Problems:

1. THE CALL IS AN INTERRUPTION

She has a lot of other things cooking! Patients waiting in the waiting room. Another call on hold. The Doctor calling for her to help out in therapy. So, she's holding a hot pack on with one hand, stuffing envelopes with the other. Can she focus and concentrate on this call? Maybe - if it is made her #1 priority. Otherwise, no.

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2. THE CALL IS MISUNDERSTOOD

The C.A. views this as an appointment scheduling call - and her job is to get the person booked and get off the phone as quickly and efficiently as possible. But this is actually a sales situation. The prospect has gotten as far as calling; she is NOT yet committed to keeping an appointment; thus, a high percentage of "I'll think it over and call you back" and a high percentage of "no shows" per appointments scheduled. Also: the C.A. has had no training in tele-selling.

3. THE CALLER'S NAME AND ADDRESS ARE NOT CAPTURED.

Follow-up is not possible.

Now the Dr. comes up on Friday and asks 'How many calls did we get from the Yellow Pages?" The CA can say: "14, but I could only schedule 4 of them, and 3 of those were no shows" OR she can say "Two, I scheduled one, and that was Mrs. Johnson who you saw yesterday." Which answer makes HER look better? Worse? Which will she prefer: having the doc mad at the Yellow Pages or at her?

A comparable situation exists in MOST businesses. How about yours?